U.S. Smartphone Import Sourcing and Tariffs: HTS 8517.13

The study covers U.S. imports for consumption of Smartphones under HTS6 851713. Data run through annual 2025 and monthly 2026-09; HTS continuity is unverified. **[Measured]** — Source: `analysis_manifest.json`

1. Key Findings and Key Numbers

China's import value contracted sharply in 2025, but the increase from other origins was larger. In the first 9 months of 2026, China's share continued to fall while total import value still increased year over year. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/focal_split.csv`

1. **China's decline did not turn into a contraction across the full HTS6 scope.** From 2024 to 2025, import value from China fell from USD 40.68 bn to USD 23.49 bn, while import value from other origins increased from USD 15.45 bn to USD 35.37 bn. Import value from all origins rose from USD 56.13 bn to USD 58.86 bn, an increase of 4.9%. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/focal_split.csv`
2. **The sourcing reallocation was concentrated among several major origins.** From 2024 to 2025, China's share fell from 72.5% to 39.9%, India's share rose from 12.1% to 39.1%, Vietnam's share rose from 14.0% to 18.3%, and South Korea's share rose from 0.7% to 2.0%. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/origin_change.csv`
3. **China's share continued to decline in the first 9 months of 2026.** From the first 9 months of 2025 to the same period of 2026, China's share fell from 39.1% to 28.4%, India's share rose from 37.1% to 44.2%, Vietnam's share rose from 21.2% to 21.7%, and South Korea's share rose from 1.9% to 4.7%. Total import value increased by 5.1% over the same period. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/origin_change.csv`
4. **The realized duty rate changed substantially, but it is not a statutory tariff rate.** China's realized duty rate increased from 0.0% to 12.6% between 2024 and 2025, then fell from 11.2% to 1.6% between the first 9 months of 2025 and the same period of 2026. The realized duty rate measures calculated duties as a share of customs value. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/origin_change.csv`
5. **Import value increased while reported quantity declined, so unit value including product mix increased.** From 2024 to 2025, import value from all origins increased by 4.9%, reported quantity declined by 6.1%, and average customs value per reported unit rose from USD 348 per unit to USD 389 per unit, an increase of 11.6%. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/origin_change.csv`

Comparison	Origin	Import value (USD bn)	Value share	Quantity change	Realized duty rate
2024→2025	China	40.68→23.49	72.5%→39.9%	-55.1%	0.0%→12.6%
2024→2025	Other origins	15.45→35.37	27.5%→60.1%	+129.4%	0.0%→0.2%
2024→2025	All origins	56.13→58.86	100.0%	-6.1%	0.0%→5.2%
First 9 months of 2025→same period of 2026	China	16.62→12.69	39.1%→28.4%	-22.0%	11.2%→1.6%
First 9 months of 2025→same period of 2026	Other origins	25.84→31.94	60.9%→71.6%	+7.5%	0.1%→0.1%
First 9 months of 2025→same period of 2026	All origins	42.46→44.63	100.0%	-3.1%	4.4%→0.6%

[Measured / Derived] — Source: `tables/focal_split.csv`

2. Tariff Timeline and Treatment Snapshot

The table retains only measures in the tariff registry with `coverage=applies` that actually cover this product. The legal label synthetic-opioid policy identifies the policy basis for a broad origin-based additional duty; it does not

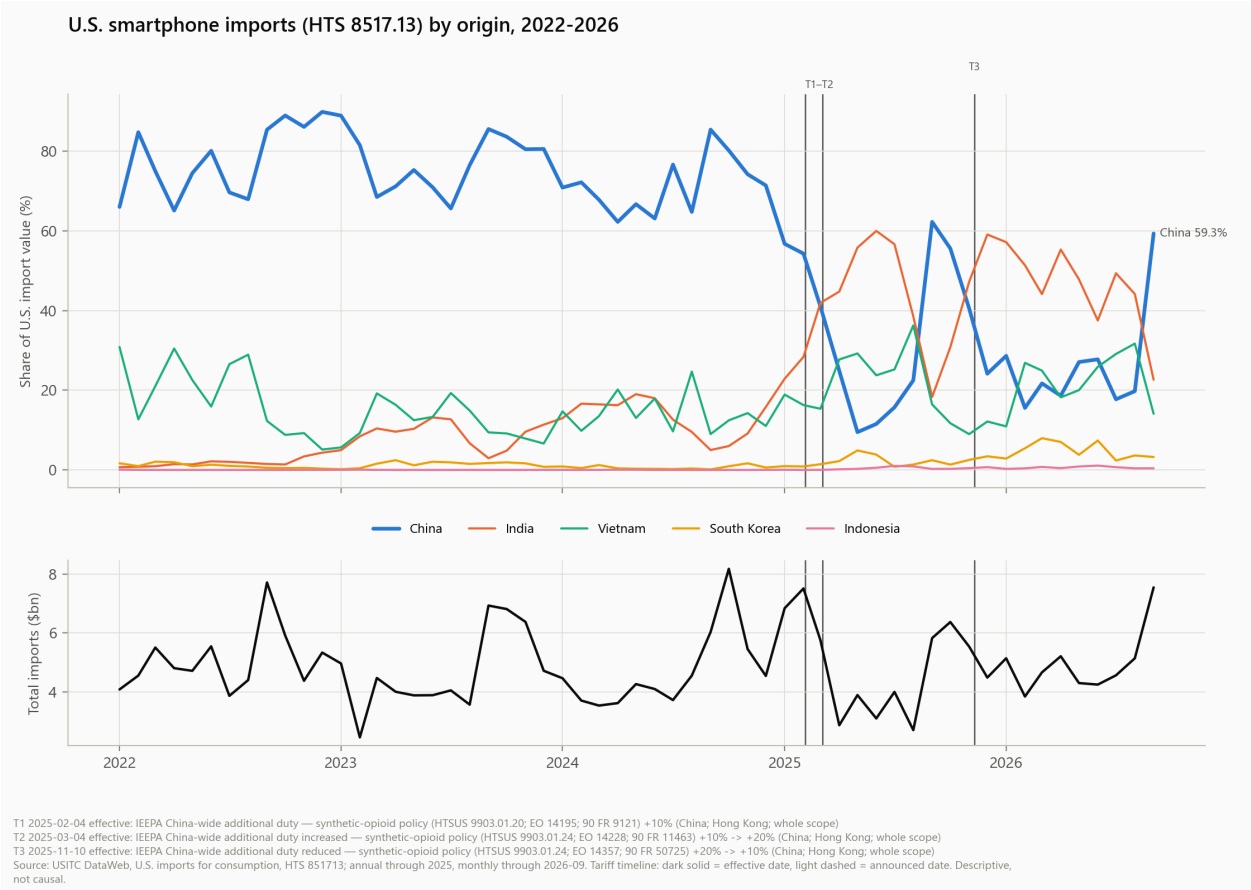
describe smartphones as synthetic-opioid products. **[Measured]** — Source: `tables/tariff_timeline.csv`

Effective date	Change that affected this product	HTSUS / Federal identifiers	Covered origins	Primary source
2025-02-04	New additional duty of +10%	9903.01.20; EO 14195; 90 FR 9121	China; Hong Kong	Federal Register
2025-03-04	+10% increased to +20%	9903.01.24; EO 14228; 90 FR 11463	China; Hong Kong	Federal Register
2025-11-10	+20% reduced to +10%	9903.01.24; EO 14357; 90 FR 50725	China; Hong Kong	Federal Register

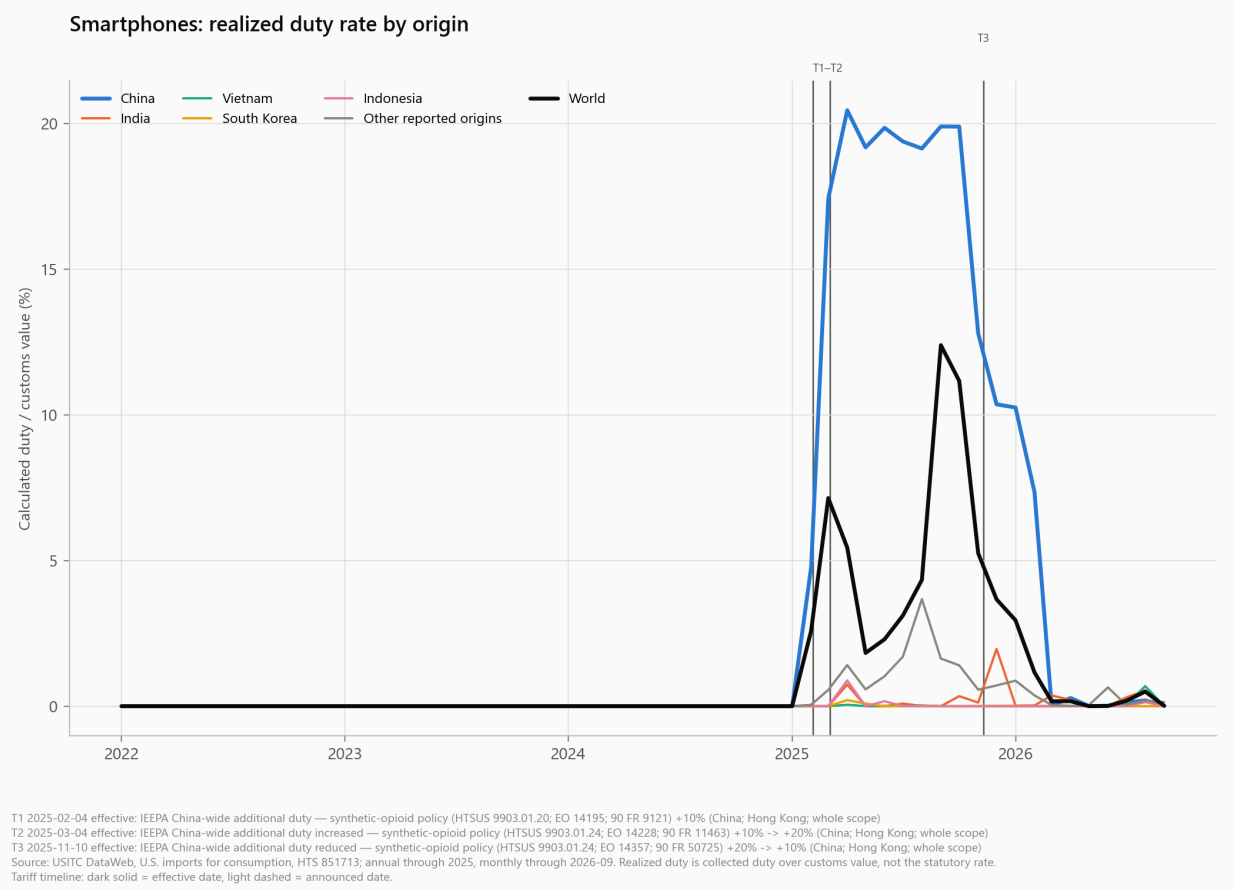
[Measured] — Source: `tables/tariff_timeline.csv`

HTS-based tariff treatment snapshot. Under the assumptions of China origin, HTS 8517.13.00.00, entry on 2026-11-09, Column 1-General treatment, no preference claim, and an ordinary consumption entry, the base rate is Free and the identified Chapter 99 layer is 9903.01.24 at +10%. The overall status remains **Unresolved**: `ieepa-ended` has no coverage rule, and the system preserves the uncertainty under its fail-closed rule. The snapshot uses 2026HTSRev22, released on 2026-10-30. It is not a CBP binding ruling. **[Measured]** — Source: `tables/tariff_treatment_snapshot.csv`

3. HTS6 Body and HTS8→HTS10 Structure



China's import-value share fell from 72.5% in 2024 to 39.9% in 2025 and reached 28.4% in the first 9 months of 2026. The policy lines in the chart show timing alignment only and do not establish causality. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/origin_change.csv`



China's realized duty rate fell from 11.2% in the first 9 months of 2025 to 1.6% in the same period of 2026. This series measures observed calculated-duty incidence and is not the HTS-based tariff treatment shown below. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/origin_change.csv`

HTS6 industry scope	HTS8 legal rate line	HTS10 statistical category	Readable category	Official English description	Unit	Column 1-General	Additional tariff	HTS10 import-value share
851713	85171300	8517130000	Smartphones	Smartphones	no.	Free	Unresolved / +10%	—

[Measured] — Source: `tables/product_hierarchy_matrix.csv`. The current cache contains only HTS6 trade data, and the HTS10 share status is `unavailable_missing_hts10_trade_rows`; existing child categories were not normalized to manufacture a share.

4. Questions Worth Asking

1. **Why is South Korea's unit value including product mix substantially higher?** In the first 9 months of 2026, it was USD 759 per unit, compared with USD 416 per unit for all origins, a difference of 1.82x. Model-level or finer product data are needed to separate price from product composition. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/anomaly_flags.csv`
2. **Does the import increase before the additional duty took effect reflect a change in order timing?** In 2025-01..2025-02, China's import value was 37% higher year over year and import value from other origins was 175% higher year over year, while the higher tariff rate took effect on 2025-03-04. DataWeb records the import month but not the order or contract date. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/anomaly_flags.csv`
3. **Why did China's realized duty rate fall to 1.6% in the first 9 months of 2026 while the current snapshot still identifies 9903.01.24 at +10%?** Answering this requires the official coverage rule for `ieepa-ended` and a

review of the Chapter 99 provisions used in actual entries. **[Unknown]** — Source: `tables/focal_split.csv`, `tables/tariff_treatment_snapshot.csv`

4. **How are product shares distributed across HTS10 statistical categories?** The current analysis lacks same-period HTS10 World data and an independently queried HTS6 World denominator, so it cannot report the product-mix shares. **[Unknown]** — Source: `tables/product_hierarchy_matrix.csv`

5. Drill-down and Next-step Menu

Parent scope	Drill-down level	Line count	Product line	Unit	HTS8 base rate	Verdict
8517.13	HTS10	1	8517.13.00.00	no.	8517.13.00: Free	Same as the parent scope; no classification-based drill-down is needed

[Measured] — Source: `tables/drilldown_menu.csv`

Priority	Next step	New work required
10	Resolve the product-level tariff treatment	official-source review
30	Measure the HTS10 product mix inside the HTS6 scope	new DataWeb download
50	Test the relationship between product mix and the unit-value signal	new data or optional network research

[Measured] — Source: `tables/next_steps.csv`. The menu describes follow-up actions only; it does not automatically browse the web or download data.

6. Notes on Measures

- **Unit value including product mix** = `CONS_CUSTOMS_VALUE / CONS_FIR_UNIT_QUANT`, measured in USD per unit. It is the average customs value per reported quantity within the selected scope, not a transaction price, company ASP, market price, or quality-adjusted price index. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/proxy_notes.csv`
- **Realized duty rate** = `CONS_CALC_DUTY / CONS_CUSTOMS_VALUE`. It measures observed calculated duties as a share of customs value. It is not a statutory tariff rate and does not prove that every entry used the same tariff provision, preference, or Chapter 99 line. **[Derived]** — Source: `tables/proxy_notes.csv`
- **Origin** is the country or area of origin reported to U.S. Customs. It does not represent the shipping country, source of value added, fabrication location, corporate supplier dependence, or transshipment-adjusted exposure. **[Measured]** — Source: `tables/proxy_notes.csv`
- Data come from USITC DataWeb imports for consumption. The maximum difference between the sum across reported origins and the independently queried World total is 0.000%, and the coverage audit found no internal gap. **[Measured]** — Source: `tables/world_check.csv`, `tables/coverage_audit.csv`
- HTS continuity is unverified. The cross-period changes are descriptive results, not causal estimates of policy effects. **[Unknown]** — Source: `analysis_manifest.json`

Appendix

The body is brief.md as written (SHA-256 d511130f66a7…); the appendix is generated by final_report from validated files.

A. Study identity

Item	Value
Product	Smartphones (HTS6: 851713)
Scope	smartphones v1 scope_sha256 `54a10caee689c6027a96c7331e578332cb3fb197443a793acabd65b0d1a74730`
Study	smartphones-2022-2026 study_sha256 `61c45a2119a8e4b927663888cd609aacf0908d3a842338fcf5adf948613bdb88`
Plan	plan_sha256 `2ca86ee6e514e7bdc6700710bfa03b71edc5eb5f684a045fb7dbddd8dbdb6031`
Data	USITC DataWeb, U.S. imports for consumption; data through annual 2025, monthly 2026-09 (queried through annual 2025, monthly 2026-12; DataWeb has no data yet after the data end)
Approval	approved (confirmed by the user in chat and recorded by the agent's scope-approve run; their words are in the scope manifest)
HTS continuity	**not verified**
Quantity	first unit no.; second unit — (basis = first)
Analysis generated (UTC)	2026-11-09T17:49:36.455225+00:00

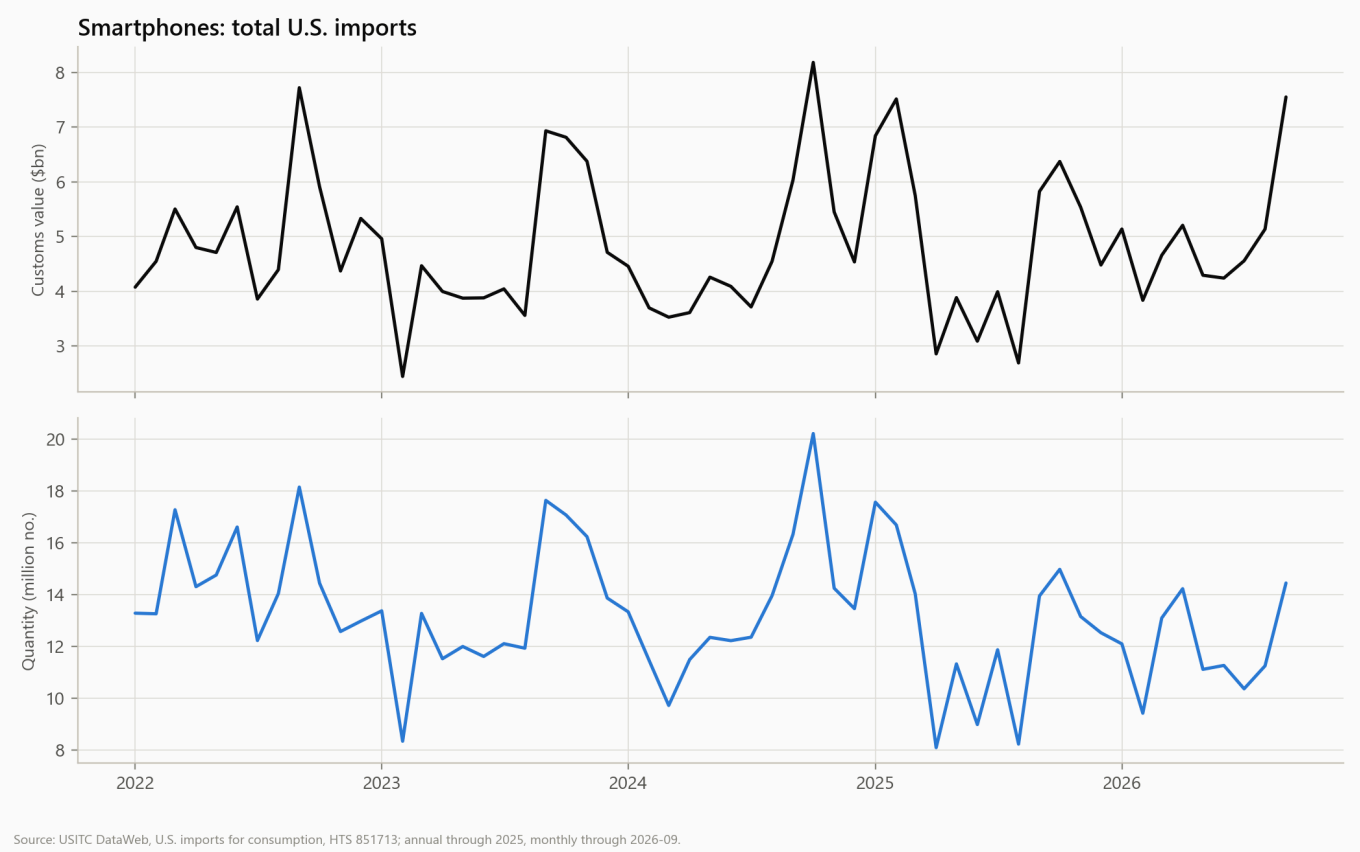
B. Data checks

Item	Value
Panel validation	passed: 4480 rows, 61 product periods, 0 errors, 0 warnings; all 9 charts have their data CSV
Origins against World	61 rows, status ok 61; largest gap: value 0.000%, quantity 0.000%, calculated duty 0.000%
Code coverage	2 code-frequency rows, 0 need review, 0 have gaps
Body brief-check	passed: 167 numeric tokens, 93 with a recognized unit, 93 found in the validated files they cite; 0 ambiguous units, 74 unitless skips; 12 files cited; 0 warnings

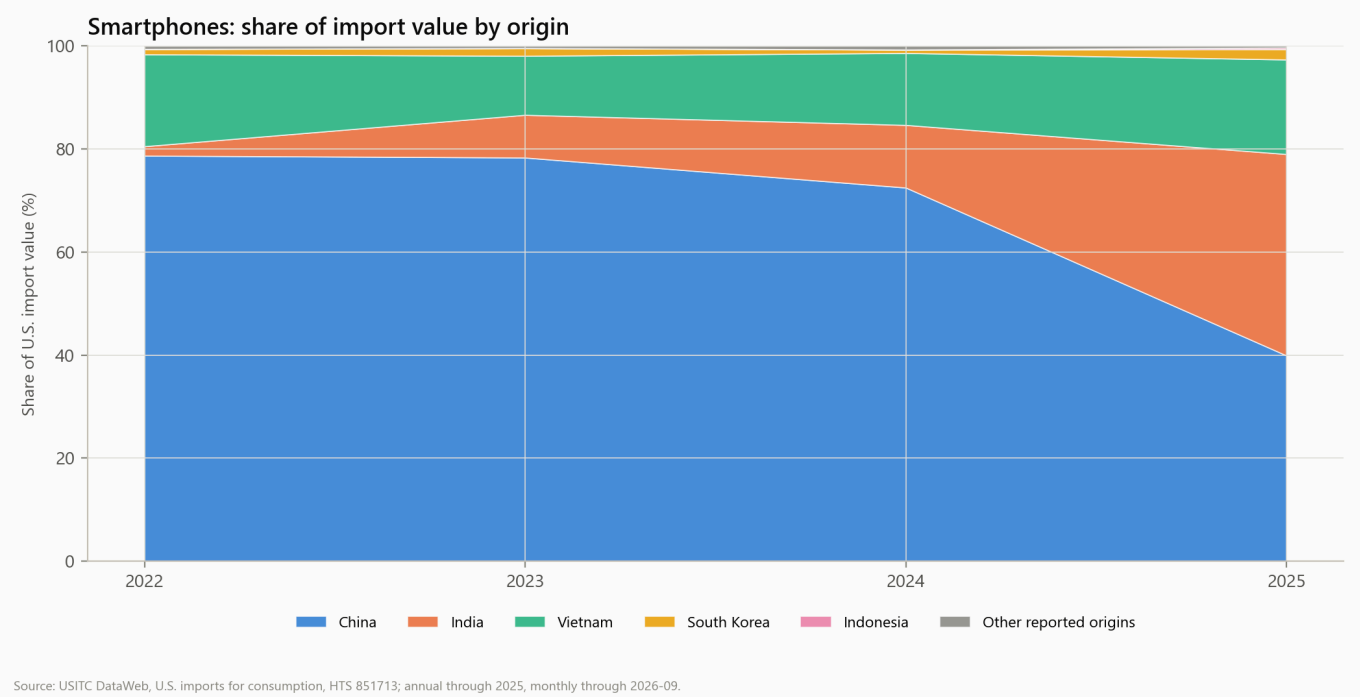
C. What this cannot show

- Country or area of origin is the origin reported to U.S. Customs; it is not value-added origin, fab location or firm dependence.
- A gaining source does not prove direct relocation from the focal origin.
- Policy-aligned timing is descriptive unless a causal design is added.
- Realized duty (calculated duty / customs value) is not the statutory tariff rate.
- The HTS tariff-treatment snapshot is non-binding research, not a CBP classification ruling or entry liquidation.
- Unit value (customs value / reported quantity) is a product-mix proxy, not a transaction price, company ASP or per-capacity price.
- HTS10 product share is a share of U.S. import customs value inside the parent HTS6, not market share or global capacity.

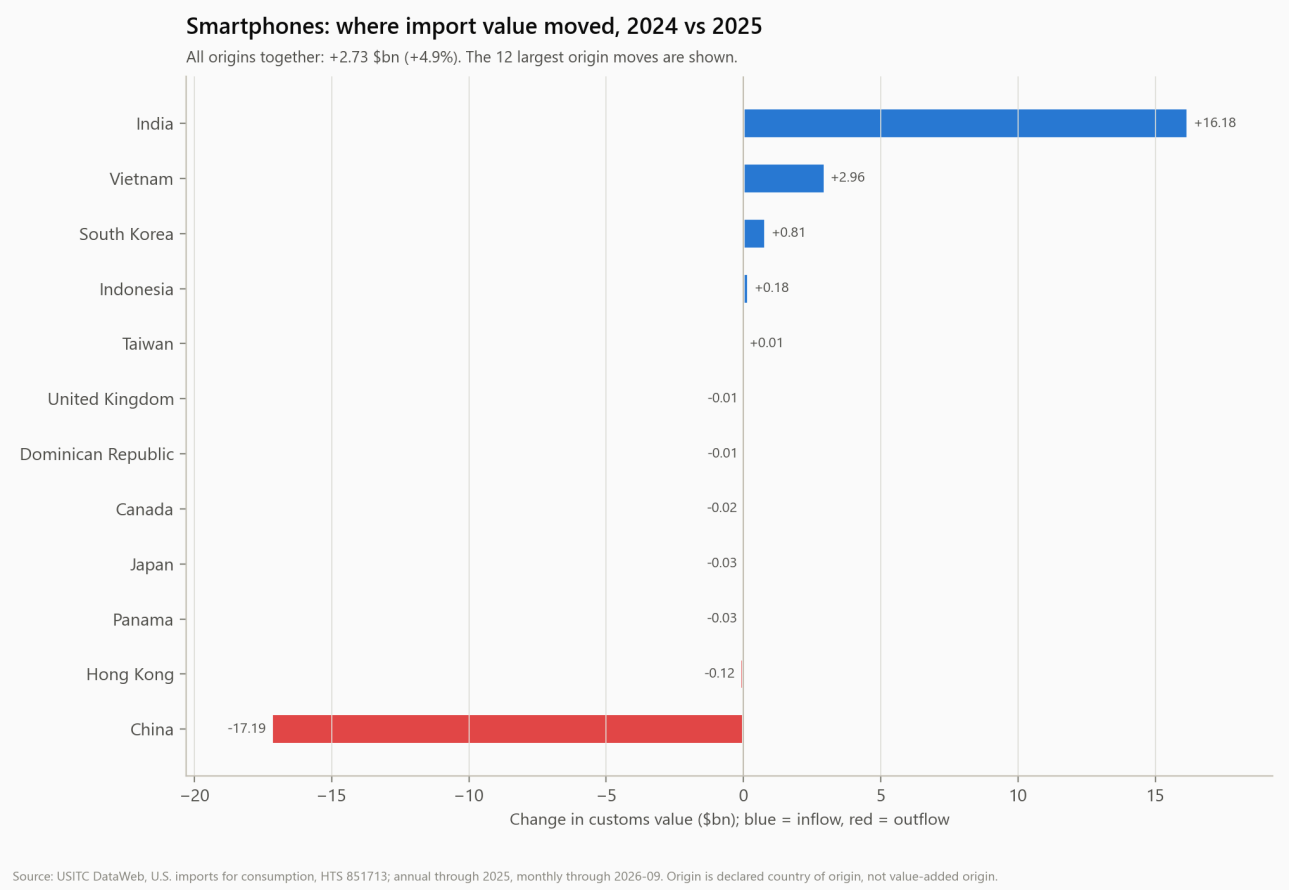
D. Other charts



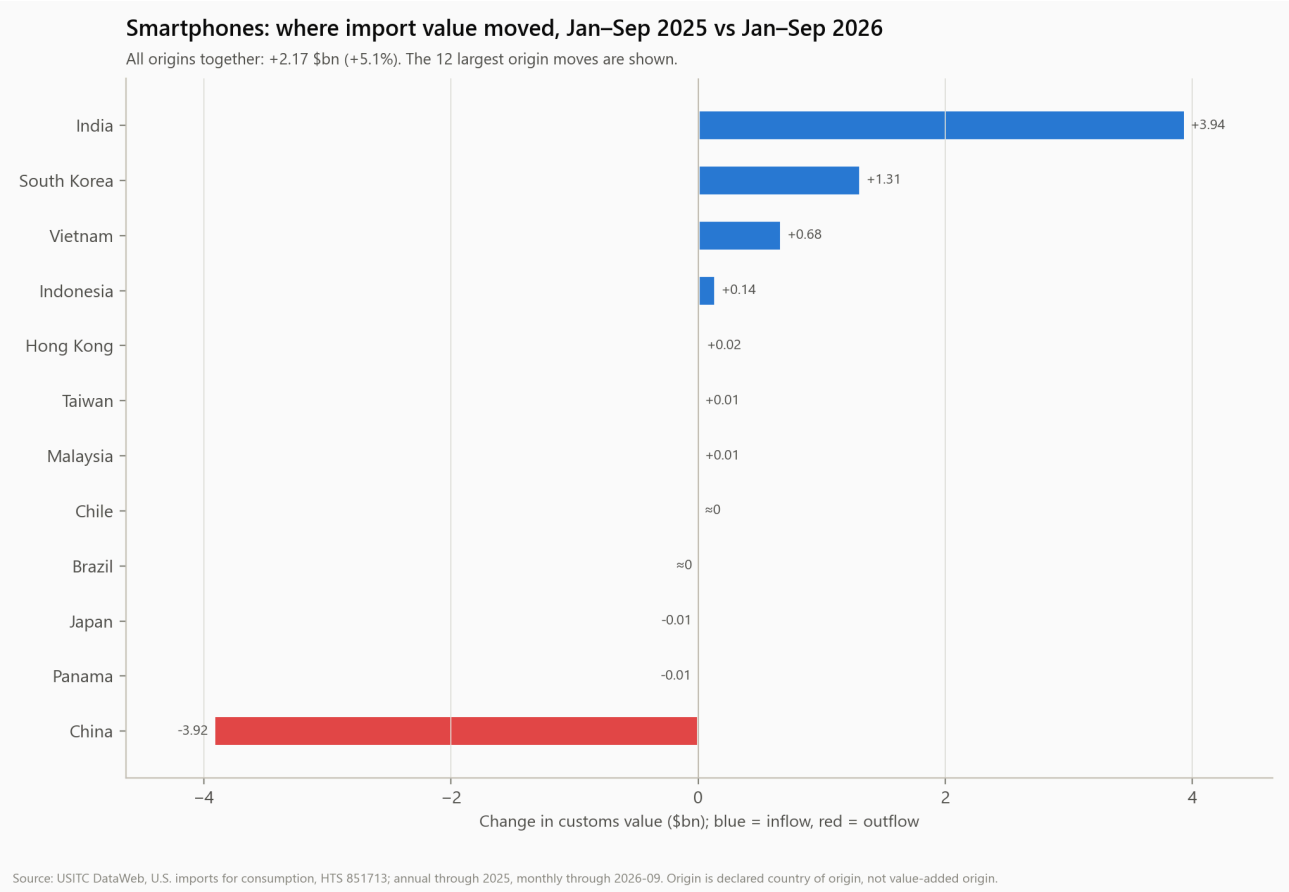
01_scope_trend · Chart data: `charts/01_scope_trend.csv`



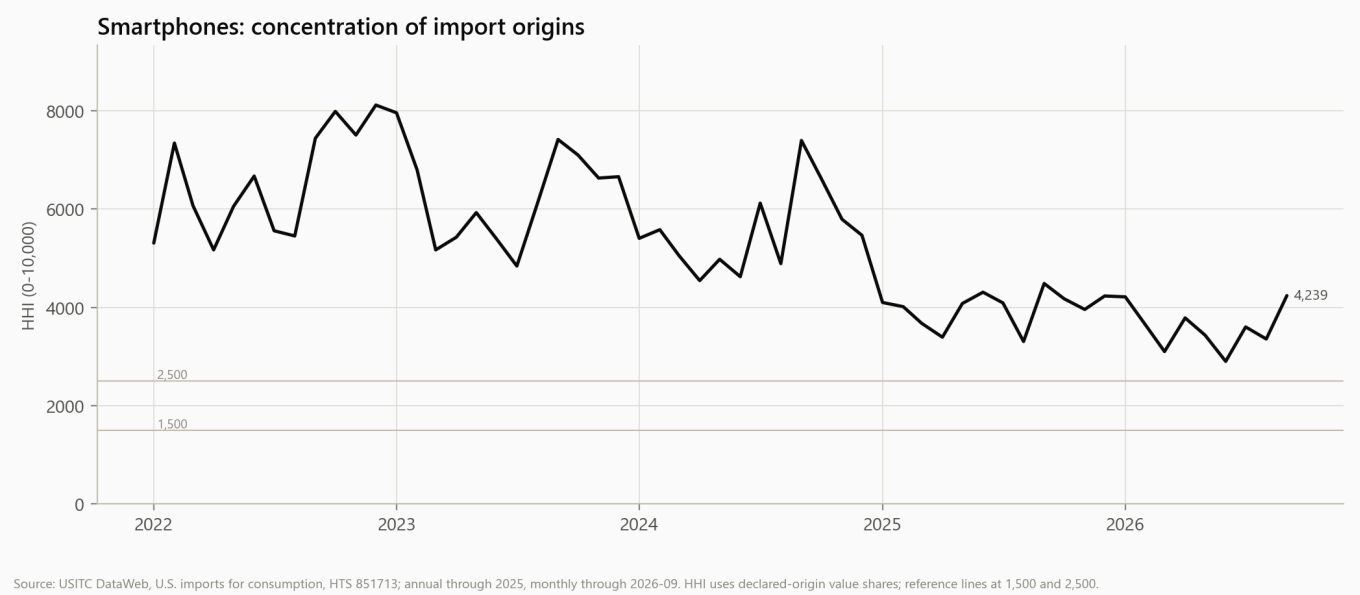
04_origin_shares · Chart data: `charts/04_origin_shares.csv`



05_origin_change · Chart data: `charts/05_origin_change.csv`

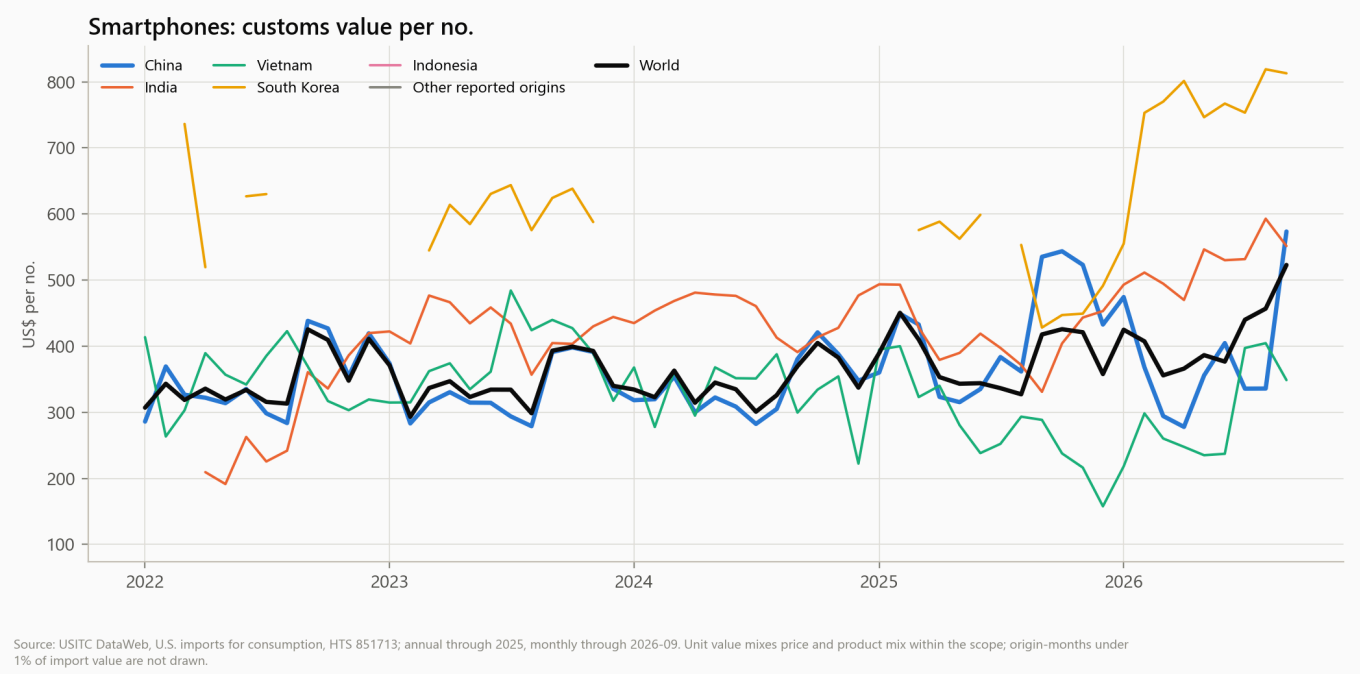


06_ytd_comparison · Chart data: `charts/06_ytd_comparison.csv`



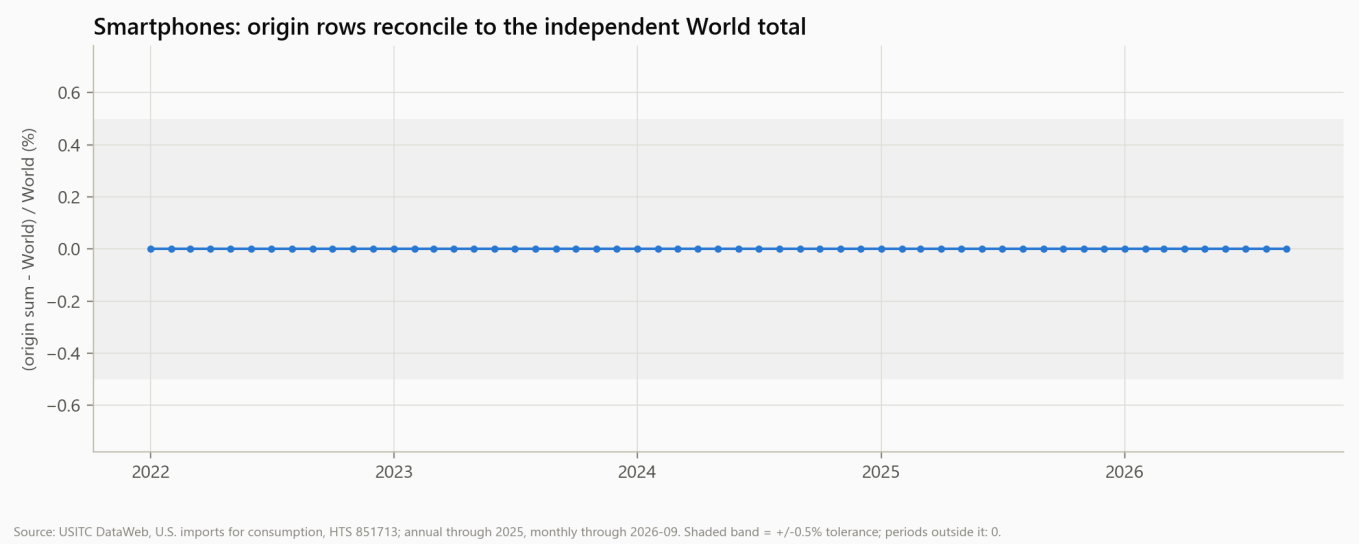
Source: USITC DataWeb, U.S. imports for consumption, HTS 851713; annual through 2025, monthly through 2026-09. HHI uses declared-origin value shares; reference lines at 1,500 and 2,500.

07_concentration · Chart data: `charts/07_concentration.csv`



Source: USITC DataWeb, U.S. imports for consumption, HTS 851713; annual through 2025, monthly through 2026-09. Unit value mixes price and product mix within the scope; origin-months under 1% of import value are not drawn.

08_unit_value · Chart data: `charts/08_unit_value.csv`



10_world_check · Chart data: `charts/10_world_check.csv`

E. Files and hashes

File	Path	SHA-256 (first 12)
brief	`brief.md`	`d511130f66a7`
anomaly_flags	`tables/anomaly_flags.csv`	`af4f2c22325e`
calculations	`tables/calculations.csv`	`f0de1f90b66e`
coverage_audit	`tables/coverage_audit.csv`	`1e8e5c67bd38`
display_series	`tables/display_series.csv`	`c86b3f7943ca`
drilldown_menu	`tables/drilldown_menu.csv`	`282be386be4a`
event_metrics	`tables/event_metrics.json`	`12a5a9942315`
findings	`findings.json`	`62d16e1ff117`
focal_split	`tables/focal_split.csv`	`290b479534c0`
mention_list	`tables/mention_list.csv`	`c52ded22efa7`
monthly_panel	`tables/monthly_panel.csv`	`030615d36c03`
next_steps	`tables/next_steps.csv`	`67c6f9fa012a`
origin_change	`tables/origin_change.csv`	`9eedeb47af89`
origin_series	`tables/origin_series.csv`	`597304d3f2c2`
product_hierarchy_matrix	`tables/product_hierarchy_matrix.csv`	`9bdc6c299791`
product_reallocation	`tables/product_reallocation.csv`	`35527a457996`
proxy_notes	`tables/proxy_notes.csv`	`24934526bf18`
scope_series	`tables/scope_series.csv`	`bd6bc096b297`
share_decomposition	`tables/share_decomposition.csv`	`591a0f7a0c99`
tariff_snapshot	`tables/tariff_treatment_snapshot.csv`	`85567f447b98`
tariff_timeline	`tables/tariff_timeline.csv`	`0c7e54bab354`
trade_panel	`processed/trade_panel.csv`	`18dbd076ccb5`
trade_tidy	`processed/trade_tidy.csv`	`d2ac62479780`
window_candidates	`tables/window_candidates.csv`	`3d61cdc6c232`
world_check	`tables/world_check.csv`	`67712e6f528c`